

Inmar Intelligence Deep Research Report

Prepared as an investor-oriented review of Inmar Intelligence and the technology-enabled transaction processing, promotions, retail media analytics and healthcare reverse-logistics markets. This report is intended to be a 20-25 page-equivalent written deliverable when exported to a standard PDF format.

Source tiers follow the requested hierarchy and are stated again in the appendix:

- Tier 1: Government, public agencies, statistical bodies and regulatory filings.
- Tier 2: Company websites, company reports, consulting firms and company newsroom releases.
- Tier 3: Financial news and industry publications.
- Tier 4: Market research aggregators, blogs and unverified sources; avoided except where explicitly noted. No Tier 4 source was used as primary support.

Executive summary slide

Section | What We Like | What We Want to Investigate Further

Company Overview | - Inmar combines coupon settlement heritage, retailer-connected digital incentives, retail media and healthcare Rx returns in transaction-heavy customer environments.

- The platform touches brands, retailers, pharmacies, wholesalers and manufacturers, creating multiple data and workflow entry points across commerce and healthcare. | - Quantify revenue mix, margins and growth by martech, incentives settlement, retail media, analytics and healthcare reverse-logistics segments.

- Validate retention, wallet share and switching costs among top retailers, CPG advertisers, pharmacies, wholesalers and life-sciences manufacturers. |

Market overview and trends | - Digital coupons, retail media and closed-loop measurement benefit from persistent v behavior and migration of grocery engagement into omnichannel workflows.

- Retailers and CPGs increasingly value first-party data, real-time personalization and measurable sales attribution, aligning with Inmar's platform positioning. | - Size Inmar's true serviceable market bottom-up by retailer integrations, manufacturer promotion budgets, transaction volume and healthcare returns addressability.

- Test how quickly CPG promotion dollars shift from paper, trade spend and impressions-based media into outcome-based digital incentives. |

Competitive Landscape | - Inmar remains relevant against Neptune, Ibotta and Catalina because it offers both prom processing and retailer/brand collaboration capabilities.

- The Ahold Delhaize USA win indicates Inmar can displace major incumbents when retailers prioritize coupon capacity, offer relevance and omnichannel efficiency. | -

Benchmark Inmar's retailer network coverage, offer inventory, redemption accuracy, fraud controls and campaign ROI against Neptune, Ibotta, Catalina and Vericast.

- Assess whether broader retail media platforms such as Criteo, Epsilon/CitrusAd and Instacart can compress Inmar's role in retailer monetization. |

Value Creation and risks | - AI-enabled personalization, universal coupon adoption, retailer media monetization and healthcare compliance provide credible future growth levers.

- Inmar's data-intensive intermediary role can create operating leverage if automation

reduces settlement, reconciliation and returns-processing cost per transaction. | - Determine whether privacy scrutiny, first-party-data fragmentation and retailer insourcing reduce third-party platform economics faster than Inmar can innovate. - Evaluate platform resiliency, cyber controls, patent exposure, customer concentration and leverage/ownership constraints before underwriting aggressive growth assumptions. |

1. Company overview

1.1 Business description

Inmar Intelligence is a Winston-Salem, North Carolina-based technology-enabled services company serving retail, consumer packaged goods, healthcare and related transaction-processing markets. The company began in 1980 by applying technology to the manual coupon settlement process, helping retailers get paid, brands track effectiveness and consumers save. Inmar now describes itself as a data-powered, AI-activated platform helping brands, retailers and healthcare companies improve consumer and patient outcomes. Inmar About, Tier 2 (<https://www.inmar.com/about>)

The company's economic role is best understood as a trusted transaction intermediary. Inmar sits between parties that need to create, validate, settle, measure or reverse a transaction: CPG brands funding promotions; retailers distributing and redeeming offers; consumers saving through loyalty and coupon channels; pharmacies sending unsaleable pharmaceuticals back for credit; and manufacturers, wholesalers or life-sciences companies needing compliant returns documentation. The same underlying capabilities recur across these domains: data ingestion, rules engines, identity or eligibility matching, settlement, reconciliation, analytics, reporting and regulatory controls.

Inmar's current public positioning emphasizes two major divisions:

1. Martech / commerce solutions: incentives, digital coupons, loyalty technology, retail media, influencer marketing, shopper intelligence, promotion management and settlement.
2. Healthcare / supply-chain solutions: Rx returns, pharmaceutical reverse logistics, disposal and destruction, data delivery, returns-policy application and compliance-oriented reporting.

OMERS Private Equity acquired a majority interest in Inmar from ABRY Partners in 2017, while ABRY continued as a significant shareholder. At that time, Inmar was described as an analytics and technology-enabled service provider with unmatched access to billions of consumer and business transactions in real time and approximately 4,500 North American team members. ABRY Partners, Tier 2

(<https://abry.com/news-article/omers-acquires-majority-interest-in-inmar/>) OMERS currently describes Inmar as a leading provider of technology-enabled processing, settlement and logistics services serving approximately 11,000 customers worldwide. OMERS Private Equity, Tier 2 (<https://www.omersprivateequity.com/investments/inmar>) Atairos also lists Inmar as a partner company and describes the business as facilitating targeted customer interactions, logistics services and financial settlement solutions

for more than 16,000 clients. Atairos, Tier 2

(<https://www.atairos.com/partner-companies/inmar-intelligence/>)

1.2 Core offerings

Offering area | Inmar capabilities | Customer groups | Strategic relevance

Digital incentives for brands | Digital coupons, cash-back offers, retailer-connected offers, loyalty/rewards program management, validation, clearing and financial settlement. | CPG manufacturers, brand advertisers and agencies. | performance-oriented promotion spend and connects manufacturer dollars to measurable transaction outcomes. Incentives and loyalty for retailers | Demand generation, offer sourcing, promotion engine, loyalty technology, AI personalization, digital wallets and real-time basket evaluation. | Grocery, drug, mass, convenience and other retail. Inmar in checkout, loyalty and shopper-engagement workflows where switching costs can develop through integrations history.

Retail media | Campaign activation and management, retailer-advertiser collaboration, ShopperReach retail-event with influencer marketing and commerce-linked measurement. | Retailers, CPG advertisers and agencies. | Gives retailers a layer and gives advertisers a path to closed-loop sales attribution using retailer transaction data.

Promotion processing and settlement | Offer creation, validation, clearing, reimbursement, reconciliation and reporting. | paper and digital incentive formats. | Retailers and manufacturers. | Historically core to Inmar; remains important for operational trust, fraud controls and settlement accuracy matter.

Healthcare Rx returns | Returns-policy application, unsaleables processing, returns credits, debit memos, reporting and disposal/destruction and counterfeit identification. | Life-sciences companies, pharmacies, wholesalers and health-system supply-chain participants. | Provides a separate regulated workflow where compliance, policy databases and reconciliation experience can sustain recurring demand.

AI, ML and automation | Enterprise AI, generative AI, robotic process automation and machine learning for operational recommendations, personalization and error reduction. | Internal operations and external customers. | Potentially a competitive structure and product differentiation if embedded into high-volume reconciliation and personalization workflows.

Inmar's incentives platform claims meaningful scale. Its brand incentives page states

the Inmar Digital Incentives Ecosystem reaches 240 million+ verified shoppers, is the #1 digital grocery incentives network in the U.S., and covers 38% ACV across the total grocery market. Inmar Incentives for Brands, Tier 2

(<https://www.inmar.com/solutions/martech/brands/incentives>) The same page positions Inmar around shopper intelligence, personalized incentives, a retailer-connected network and closed-loop measurement tied to transaction outcomes.

For retailers, Inmar's Promotion Engine supports 60+ types of online and in-store promotions and uses an API-driven engine to evaluate digital wallets and apply discounts at checkout in real time. Inmar Incentives & Loyalty, Tier 2

(<https://www.inmar.com/solutions/martech/retailers/incentives-loyalty>) This is strategically important because a retailer's promotion workflow must operate across mobile app, e-commerce, loyalty account and physical checkout environments. Failures in offer eligibility, redemption timing or settlement accuracy can damage customer trust and manufacturer relationships.

In healthcare, Inmar states that its Rx Returns solutions are used across the healthcare value chain and are available in the U.S. and Canada for life-sciences returns. The platform applies manufacturer return goods policies, supports counterfeit identification, offers SOC-compliant processing models, generates debit memos, supports disposal/destruction and provides reporting/analytics. Inmar Rx Returns, Tier 2
(<https://www.inmar.com/solutions/healthcare/supply-chain-solutions/rx-returns>)

1.3 Key geographies

Inmar is primarily a North American platform, with strongest public evidence in the United States and Canada.

- United States: Core market for digital grocery incentives, retail media, CPG promotions, coupon settlement, grocery/drug/mass-retail integrations and pharmaceutical returns.
- Canada: Explicitly included in Rx Returns availability for life-sciences companies, and Neptune/Checkout 51 competitor data reinforces that North American coupon and cashback networks often operate across the U.S. and Canada. Inmar Rx Returns, Tier 2 (<https://www.inmar.com/solutions/healthcare/supply-chain-solutions/rx-returns>); Neptune Digital Incentives, Tier 2 (<https://neptuneretailsolutions.com/solutions/digital-incentives/>)
- International operations: Inmar's leadership page references international operations in Mexico and India, suggesting operating support or delivery centers rather than clearly evidenced customer-market concentration. Inmar Leadership, Tier 2 (<https://www.inmar.com/about/leadership>)

1.4 Ownership and leadership

Inmar is privately held. OMERS Private Equity acquired a majority interest in 2017; ABRY remained a significant shareholder. ABRY Partners, Tier 2 (<https://abry.com/news-article/omers-acquires-majority-interest-in-inmar/>) Inmar's current board listing includes representatives from OMERS, ABRY and Atairos, while Atairos lists Inmar as a partner company. Inmar Leadership, Tier 2 (<https://www.inmar.com/about/leadership>); Atairos, Tier 2 (<https://www.atairos.com/partner-companies/inmar-intelligence/>)

Spencer Baird is CEO. He joined Inmar in 2020 as Chief Transformation Officer and became CEO in September 2022. Inmar describes the current period under his leadership as one involving leadership and cultural change, enterprise portfolio optimization and a customer-centric foundation for organic growth and market leadership. Inmar Leadership, Tier 2 (<https://www.inmar.com/about/leadership>) The executive team also includes dedicated leaders for martech, healthcare, technology, AI, legal/privacy and information security, which is relevant for a platform exposed to consumer data, campaign economics, settlement flows and regulated healthcare supply-chain data.

1.5 Industry and sub-sector classification

Classification lens | Best-fit classification | Rationale

GICS, standalone primary view | Information Technology / Software & Services / IT Services / Data Processing & Outsourcing Services
| Inmar processes, validates, settles and analyzes high-volume commerce and healthcare transactions for enterprise clients.
GICS, secondary view | Communication Services or Consumer Discretionary exposure through advertising and retail media
Martech and retail media economics depend on advertising budgets, retailer monetization and CPG marketing spend.
Healthcare segment view | Health Care / Health Care Equipment & Services / Health Care Services or Healthcare Technology
Returns supports pharmaceutical reverse logistics, compliance, product disposition and supply-chain analytics.
PICS-style private-market view | Tech-enabled business services / Marketing technology / Retail media and digital advertising

Healthcare reverse logistics | This classification best captures the mixture of workflow software, data services, operations and regulated logistics.

2. Direct competitors and ranked peer set

The peer set below prioritizes companies with overlapping offerings in digital incentives, coupon processing, retail media, closed-loop measurement, shopper analytics, promotion settlement or healthcare reverse distribution, and with broadly similar North American market exposure.

Rank | Peer | Relevance score | One-line business description | Reason for score

- 1 | Neptune Retail Solutions | High | North American omnichannel shopper marketing and digital incentives network coupons, rebates, cash back, in-store media and RevTrax-powered Universal Mobile Offer. Neptune, Tier 2 (<https://neptuneretailsolutions.com/solutions/digital-incentives/>) | Strongest direct overlap in digital coupons, integrations, cash-back incentives, in-store media and CPG promotion budgets; recently displaced by Inmar at Ahold.
- 2 | Ibotta | High | AI-enabled digital promotions and performance marketing network connecting CPG brands to consumer retailer and publisher integrations. Ibotta IPN, Tier 2 (<https://ipn.ibotta.com/>) | Competes directly for CPG digital dollars, item-level offers, cashback economics, retailer-publisher integrations and closed-loop measurement.
- 3 | Catalina / Infillion | High | Shopper intelligence and personalized CPG marketing platform using purchase data to understand, activate and measure audiences. Catalina, Tier 2 (<https://www.catalina.com/>) | Longstanding competitor in promotions, shopper data, coupon activation, retail and CPG relationships, though less visibly tied to healthcare reverse logistics.
- 4 | Vericast / Valassis | Medium-High | Consumer activation company historically known for coupon, direct mail, print offers and Universal Coupon enablement. Vericast PRNewswire, Tier 3 (<https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/vericast-leads-innovation-and-promotes-adoption-of-universal-coupons-at-ahold.html>) | Strong overlap in coupons and omnichannel consumer incentives; less evidence of same depth in retailer loyalty or Rx returns.
- 5 | Swiftly | Medium-High | AI-powered retail technology and retail media platform for regional and independent grocery convenience retailers. Swiftly, Tier 2 (<https://www.swiftly.com/products/retail-media>) | Relevant in grocery retail for personalized offers, coupons and transaction-linked attribution, particularly among independent and regional retailers.
- 6 | Criteo | Medium | Global commerce media and retail media platform serving 4,000+ brands and 200+ retailers with advertising and closed-loop measurement. Criteo, Tier 2 (<https://www.criteo.com/solutions/retail-media/>) | Competes for retail media budgets and measurement workflows but less directly for coupon clearing and healthcare reverse logistics.
- 7 | Epsilon / CitrusAd | Medium | Publicis-owned retail media platform combining on-site sponsored products with coupon activation, identity data, clean rooms and SKU-level measurement. Publicis/Epsilon, Tier 2 (<https://www.epsilon.com/us/about-us/pressroom/publicis-groupe-launches-the-industrys-first-unified-on-site-and-off-site-retail-media-platform-citrusad-powered-by-epsilon>) | Strong retail media and first-party data competitor, but more media-pull than incentives settlement or pharmaceutical returns.
- 8 | Instacart Ads | Medium | North American grocery advertising ecosystem connecting CPG brands with high-intent shoppers marketplace, store and partner retail media channels. Instacart, Tier 2 (<https://www.instacart.com/company/instacart-ads/growth-incremental-sales-and-scale>) | Competes for grocery CPG media coupons and closed-loop measurement, though it is anchored in Instacart's marketplace and retailer partnerships.
- 9 | Vestcom / Avery Dennison | Medium | Shelf-edge media and retail solutions provider delivering item-specific promotions and brand content in print and digital formats. Vestcom, Tier 2 (<https://www.vestcom.com/solutions/>) | Overlaps in promotional media and retail monetization; less direct in digital wallet, coupon settlement and brand incentives network.
- 10 | Flipp | Medium-Low | Digital savings platform aggregating weekly ads, flyers, shopping lists, deals and coupons for US and Canadian retailers. Flipp, Tier 2 (<https://flipp.com/>) | Competes for consumer deal discovery and retailer circulation digitization, but has less evident settlement, closed-loop attribution and enterprise workflow breadth.
- 11 | Pharma Logistics | Medium-Low | Pharmaceutical reverse distributor serving hospitals, retail pharmacies, government and closed-door pharmacies with returns, disposal and analytics. Pharma Logistics, Tier 2 (<https://pharmalogistics.com>) | Healthcare Rx returns competitor, but no material overlap with Inmar's martech, retail media or digital incentives network.
- 12 | PharmaLink | Medium-Low | Pharmaceutical reverse distributor providing returns services for pharmacies, manufacturers, wholesalers and hospitals with Encore reporting. PharmaLink, Tier 2 (<https://pharmalinkinc.com/>) | Relevant to Inmar Rx Returns segment; narrower than Inmar because it lacks commerce media and incentives operations.
- 13 | Skai | Low-Medium | Unified retail media platform for brands to manage campaigns across 100+ retail media networks and commerce media platforms. Skai, Tier 2 (<https://skai.io/retail-media-solutions/>) | Relevant to retail media workflow indirect because it aggregates ad buying rather than operating coupon processing or returns workflows.

3. Source identification and prioritization for market research

Research need | Priority sources used | Tier | Why prioritized

Retail e-commerce transaction context | U.S. Census Bureau data via FRED series ECOMPCTSA and ECOMSA | Tier 1 | Official statistical data for e-commerce share and sales; relevant because digital offers and retail media increasingly open omnichannel retail.

Consumer price/value pressure | U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics CPI data via FRED and BLS release summaries | Tier 1 | Official inflation data supports why consumers seek deals and why retailers emphasize value communications.

Privacy and data regulation | FTC privacy and data security enforcement update | Tier 1 | Official regulator source for monetization, AI, health privacy and advertising-related enforcement risks.

Healthcare supply-chain regulation | FDA DSCSA law and policy page | Tier 1 | Official regulator source for packaging verification and supply-chain compliance relevant to Rx returns.

Digital promotions market structure | Ibotta SEC prospectus and annual filing | Tier 1 | Public regulatory filings provide detailed market context, definitions, revenue model and promotion network economics.

Retail media outlook | Deloitte retail media/personalization article; McKinsey commerce media analysis | Tier 2 | Both sources provide market outlook, monetization themes and data-infrastructure implications.

Grocery shopper behavior | FMI U.S. Grocery Shopper Trends release | Tier 3 | Industry association data directly supports coupon and value-seeking behavior in grocery.

Company and peer capabilities | Inmar, Neptune, Ibotta, Catalina, Swiftly, Criteo, Epsilon, Instacart, Vestcom, PharmaLink | Tier 2 | Company sources provide current product scope, scale metrics and positioning.

Recent customer and competitive developments | Ahold Delhaize USA press release; Grocery Dive coverage | Tier 2 / 3 | Confirms Inmar replacing Neptune as ADUSA's digital coupon provider and provides context around value-driven grocery.

4. Industry overview and market trends

4.1 Definition of the relevant industry

Inmar does not fit neatly into a single conventional market. The most investable definition is:

> Technology-enabled transaction processing and analytics platforms for retail promotions, shopper engagement, retail media, coupon settlement and regulated healthcare reverse logistics.

This market is adjacent to, but distinct from, generic advertising technology or pure e-commerce software. Inmar's workflows must connect marketing intent to operational execution: an offer must be funded, distributed, clipped or activated, validated at point of sale, reconciled to a manufacturer, measured against sales and protected against fraud or abuse. In healthcare, an unsaleable pharmaceutical product must be identified, matched against manufacturer policy, shipped or processed, credited, reported, disposed of and documented for compliance.

The highest-value platforms in this market tend to have five characteristics:

1. Transaction access: direct or indirect connections into retailer POS, loyalty, e-commerce, pharmacy or wholesaler systems.
2. Rules and eligibility engines: ability to apply promotion terms, return policies, offer stacking restrictions, manufacturer reimbursement rules or compliance requirements.

3. Data and identity resolution: ability to match offers, shoppers, products, purchases, retailers and campaign objectives.
4. Settlement and reconciliation: ability to move or account for funds, credits, debit memos, reimbursement claims and campaign budgets.
5. Measurement and optimization: ability to prove incremental sales, personalization effectiveness, fraud reduction, credit recovery, compliance adherence or ROI.

4.2 Historical market trends over the last five years

Trend | Evidence and source tier | Implication for Inmar and peers

E-commerce penetration reset higher after COVID and continued to rise gradually | U.S. Census data via FRED shows of total retail sales increased from 11.2% in Q4 2019 to 15.5% in Q4 2023, 16.2% in Q4 2024 and 16.4% in Q3 2025. Census, Tier 1 (<https://fred.stlouisfed.org/data/ECOMPCTSA.txt>) | Digital coupons and retail media must work across and store channels; omnichannel promotion engines become more important than standalone paper clearing.

E-commerce transaction dollars expanded meaningfully | U.S. Census data via FRED shows quarterly e-commerce sales billion in Q4 2019 to \$276.8 billion in Q4 2023 and \$300.4 billion in Q4 2024. FRED / U.S. Census, Tier 1 (<https://fred.stlouisfed.org/data/ECOMSA.txt>) | Higher digital transaction volume increases addressable touchpoint offers, retailer media impressions, closed-loop attribution and personalization.

Inflation reinforced deal-seeking behavior | BLS reported food-at-home prices increased 11.8% from December 2021 to December 2022, then 1.3% from December 2022 to December 2023; food and beverage CPI remained elevated in 2024-2026. BLS, Tier 1 (<https://www.bls.gov/opub/ted/2024/consumer-price-index-2023-in-review.htm>); FRED / BLS, Tier 1 (<https://fred.stlouisfed.org/data/CPIFABSL.txt>) | Even as inflation moderates, the price level is higher; retailers need precise value delivery rather than broad discounting.

Grocery shoppers adopted digital value tools | FMI's 2024 Grocery Shopper Trends release states 50% of shoppers use digital coupons, exceeding 37% using physical coupons, and 37% use mobile phones to compare prices across stores. FMI, Tier 1 (<https://www.fmi.org/newsroom/news-archive/view/2024/05/14/fmi-launches-2024-u.s.-grocery-shopper-trends-series--finding-value-at-the-grocery-store>) | Digital coupon networks, real-time wallets and retailer app integrations have become mainstream grocery infrastructure rather than experimental channels.

CPG promotion spend is shifting toward measurable digital outcomes | Ibotta's IPO prospectus states 87% of grocery promotions are influenced by offers, discounts and promotions, digital promotions now make up the majority of consumer promotions. Ibotta SEC prospectus, Tier 1 (<https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1538379/000162828024016660/ibotta424b4finalprospectus.htm>) | Platforms that offer redemption, incrementality and offer efficiency should take share from less measurable promotion and media tactics.

Retail media became a major monetization priority | Deloitte cites forecasts for U.S. retail media ad spend to exceed \$100 billion by 2027 and argues retailers need integrated data infrastructure and personalization strategies. Deloitte, Tier 2 (<https://www.deloitte.com/us/en/programs/chief-marketing-officer/articles/personalization-strategy-in-retail-media.html>) | Retailers can monetize first-party data, but need technology that balances ad revenue, personalized experience and conversion.

Privacy and data enforcement intensified | FTC's 2023 privacy update states the agency is challenging indiscriminate collection and monetization of consumer data and brought actions involving AI, health privacy and data security. FTC, Tier 1 (<https://www.ftc.gov/news-events/news/press-releases/2024/03/ftc-releases-2023-privacy-data-security-update>) | Data platforms must invest in consent, governance, security, minimization and defensible use of sensitive or transactional data.

Healthcare supply-chain traceability requirements advanced | FDA's DSCSA policy page tracks guidance for enhanced drug distribution security, package-level tracing, verification and interoperable systems. FDA, Tier 1 (<https://www.fda.gov/drugs/drug-supply-chain-security-act-dscsa/drug-supply-chain-security-act-law-and-policies>) | Healthcare providers with policy databases, reporting and compliance processes can benefit from complexity, but execution faces significant regulatory risk.

4.3 Market size and growth indicators

The directly addressable market for Inmar is not publicly disclosed as a single clean number. However, several adjacent spending pools illustrate why the category is strategically meaningful.

- Retail e-commerce: U.S. e-commerce sales were approximately \$300.4 billion in Q4 2024

on a seasonally adjusted basis, with e-commerce representing 16.2% of total retail sales. FRED / U.S. Census, Tier 1 (<https://fred.stlouisfed.org/data/ECOMSA.txt>)

- Grocery transaction base: Ibotta's prospectus states U.S. consumers spent approximately \$1.2 trillion in grocery in 2023, with in-store sales still comprising 87% of grocery sales. Ibotta SEC prospectus, Tier 1 (<https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1538379/000162828024016660/ibotta424b4finalprospectus.htm>)

- CPG marketing spend: Ibotta's prospectus states CPG brands spend approximately \$200 billion annually in the U.S. to shape consumer purchase behaviors. Ibotta SEC prospectus, Tier 1 (<https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1538379/000162828024016660/ibotta424b4finalprospectus.htm>)

- Retail media forecast: Deloitte cites forecasts for U.S. retail media ad spend to exceed \$100 billion by 2027. Deloitte, Tier 2 (<https://www.deloitte.com/us/en/programs/chief-marketing-officer/articles/personalization-strategy-in-retail-media.html>)

- Commerce media growth: McKinsey projects the U.S. commerce media market will reach more than \$100 billion by 2027, with 2023-2027 CAGR above 21%. McKinsey, Tier 2 (<https://www.mckinsey.com/capabilities/growth-marketing-and-sales/our-insights/the-evolution-of-commerce-media-navigating-a-new-era-in-advertising>)

- Digital incentives network scale: Inmar reports 240 million+ verified shoppers in its digital incentives ecosystem and 38% ACV coverage across the total grocery market. Inmar Incentives for Brands, Tier 2 (<https://www.inmar.com/solutions/martech/brands/incentives>)

The most relevant conclusion is not that Inmar participates in every dollar of these pools. Rather, the company sits at the intersection of large, recurring, measurable spending categories: promotion budgets, retail media budgets, loyalty engagement, grocery transactions and healthcare returns. Investor diligence should focus on take rate, retailer coverage, manufacturer wallet share, settlement volume, digital migration and segment margin, not just broad market forecasts.

4.4 Product segmentation trends

Digital coupons and cash back. Digital coupon adoption is no longer a niche behavior. FMI reports digital coupon use among grocery shoppers exceeds physical coupon use, while Ibotta argues digital promotions now comprise the majority of consumer promotions. FMI, Tier 3

(<https://www.fmi.org/newsroom/news-archive/view/2024/05/14/fmi-launches-2024-u.s.-grocery-shopper-trends-series--how-consumers-are-finding-value-at-the-grocery-store>); Ibotta SEC prospectus, Tier 1 (<https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1538379/000162828024016660/ibotta424b4finalprospectus.htm>) This favors Inmar, Neptune and Ibotta, but also raises performance expectations: brands want offer efficiency, incrementality and protection against subsidizing purchases that would have happened anyway.

Retail media and commerce media. Retail media has expanded from sponsored search on large marketplaces into a broader commerce media ecosystem using retailer first-party data, off-site activation, closed-loop measurement and in-store media. Deloitte highlights the need to align retail media with personalization and customer experience rather than treating it as a siloed monetization strategy. Deloitte, Tier 2 (<https://www.deloitte.com/us/en/programs/chief-marketing-officer/articles/personalization-strategy-in-retail-media.html>)

Loyalty and personalization. Retailer loyalty programs have become the consumer-facing surface for digital offers. Inmar's retailer incentives page positions AI-driven personalization, points/perks, digital coupons, gamified challenges and real-time personalization at scale. Inmar Incentives & Loyalty, Tier 2 (<https://www.inmar.com/solutions/martech/retailers/incentives-loyalty>) This segment increasingly overlaps with customer data platforms, identity resolution and marketing automation.

Universal coupons and fraud controls. The industry is moving toward more secure, traceable, single-use digital coupon formats, including serialized universal coupons. Neptune's UMO emphasizes AI-based personalization and fraud elimination; Vericast has promoted Universal Coupon adoption at scale using serialized 8112 barcode capabilities. Neptune, Tier 2 (<https://neptuneretailsolutions.com/solutions/digital-incentives/>); Vericast PRNewswire, Tier 3 (<https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/vericast-leads-innovation-and-promotes-adoption-of-universal-coupons-at-scale-301504108.html>)

Healthcare reverse logistics. Pharmaceutical returns are becoming more data- and compliance-intensive as DSCSA package-level traceability evolves. Inmar, Pharma Logistics and PharmaLink each position around compliance, credit recovery, reporting and workflow visibility. FDA, Tier 1 (<https://www.fda.gov/drugs/drug-supply-chain-security-act-dscsa/drug-supply-chain-security-act-law-and-policies>); Pharma Logistics, Tier 2 (<https://pharmalogistics.com/>); PharmaLink, Tier 2 (<https://pharmalinkinc.com/>)

4.5 Geographic trends

The United States is the core market for Inmar's digital grocery incentives, CPG promotion budgets and retail media opportunity. The U.S. has a large and fragmented grocery ecosystem, meaningful CPG advertising budgets and a mixture of national, regional and independent retailers. This fragmentation creates opportunities for third-party networks and platforms, but also makes retailer integrations, data sharing and offer standardization complex.

Canada is relevant in healthcare Rx returns and in North American digital incentives. Inmar explicitly offers life-sciences Rx Returns in the U.S. and Canada, while Neptune's Checkout 51 has members across the U.S. and Canada. Inmar Rx Returns, Tier 2 (<https://www.inmar.com/solutions/healthcare/supply-chain-solutions/rx-returns>); Neptune,

Tier 2 (<https://neptuneretailsolutions.com/solutions/digital-incentives/>)

Global expansion is most evident among retail media platforms such as Criteo and Epsilon/CitrusAd, which serve multinational retailers and brands. Criteo reports 4,000+ brands and 200+ retailers globally; Epsilon/CitrusAd reports operations across more than 100 retailers in 32 countries. Criteo, Tier 2

(<https://www.criteo.com/solutions/retail-media/>); Publicis/Epsilon, Tier 2

(<https://www.epsilon.com/us/about-us/pressroom/publicis-groupe-launches-the-industrys-first-unified-on-site-and-off-site-retail-media-platform-citrusad-powered-by-epsilon>)

Inmar's public evidence is more North America-centered, which can be attractive for depth but may limit global platform narratives unless additional international growth is documented.

5. Future market outlook over the next five years

5.1 Market size and growth outlook

Retail media and commerce media are expected to remain major growth corridors. Deloitte cites forecasts for U.S. retail media ad spend to exceed \$100 billion by 2027, while McKinsey projects U.S. commerce media to exceed \$100 billion by 2027 at more than 21% CAGR from 2023 to 2027. Deloitte, Tier 2

(<https://www.deloitte.com/us/en/programs/chief-marketing-officer/articles/personalization-strategy-in-retail-media.html>); McKinsey, Tier 2

(<https://www.mckinsey.com/capabilities/growth-marketing-and-sales/our-insights/the-evolution-of-commerce-media-navigating-a-new-era-in-advertising>)

Digital incentives should also continue to benefit from four structural forces:

1. Consumers remain value-sensitive after food and household prices reset upward.
2. Retailers want loyalty engagement that increases trips, baskets and app usage.
3. CPG brands need measurable conversion as marketing budgets face ROI scrutiny.
4. Paper-based promotion formats decline as digital wallets, retailer apps and cash-back networks scale.

In healthcare, regulatory complexity, traceability and pressure on pharmacy operations should sustain demand for outsourced reverse-distribution and compliance workflow providers. FDA's DSCSA policy trajectory shows continued emphasis on electronic, interoperable, package-level drug distribution security. FDA, Tier 1

(<https://www.fda.gov/drugs/drug-supply-chain-security-act-dscsa/drug-supply-chain-security-act-law-and-policies>)

5.2 Emerging trends

Closed-loop measurement becomes table stakes. Retailers and CPGs increasingly expect direct linkage between marketing spend and sales outcomes. Criteo, Ibotta, Inmar, Instacart and Epsilon/CitrusAd all position around sales-level measurement, meaning this capability is necessary but not sufficient. Differentiation will shift toward

incrementality proof, offer efficiency, audience quality and workflow simplicity.

AI moves from feature to operating model. Inmar describes enterprise AI, GenAI, RPA and ML as embedded across operations, marketing recommendations, content, personalization, error reduction and proactive decision-making. Inmar AI/ML, Tier 2 (<https://www.inmar.com/about/ai-ml>) Future winners should use AI not only to target shoppers but also to automate reconciliation, detect fraud, forecast promotion liability and optimize returns processing.

Retailer control over first-party data increases. Retailers want to monetize data but also protect customer relationships. Deloitte warns that retail media monetization must not damage customer experience and recommends integrated customer data infrastructure. Deloitte, Tier 2 (<https://www.deloitte.com/us/en/programs/chief-marketing-officer/articles/personalization-strategy-in-retail-media.html>) Third-party platforms must prove they enhance retailer control rather than disintermediate it.

Universal coupon standards and fraud prevention gain importance. As digital coupons scale, fraud, offer stacking and duplicate redemption risks become more material. Platforms that provide secure, single-use, serialized and auditable incentives can reduce leakage and improve manufacturer trust.

Healthcare reverse logistics becomes more data-driven. Rx returns are increasingly about analytics, compliance documentation, policy databases and traceability, not just physical reverse distribution. Inmar's positioning around policy accuracy, reporting, counterfeit identification and SOC-compliant processing aligns with this trend. Inmar Rx Returns, Tier 2 (<https://www.inmar.com/solutions/healthcare/supply-chain-solutions/rx-returns>)

5.3 Potential challenges and risks

Privacy and data-use scrutiny. FTC enforcement around consumer data, AI and health privacy raises the compliance bar for platforms handling transaction, location, health-adjacent or behavioral data. FTC, Tier 1 (<https://www.ftc.gov/news-events/news/press-releases/2024/03/ftc-releases-2023-privacy-data-security-update>)

Measurement skepticism. As every platform claims closed-loop attribution, advertisers may scrutinize incrementality and demand transparent methodologies. Vendors that cannot separate incremental sales from subsidized baseline demand may face pricing pressure.

Retailer insourcing. Large retailers may build proprietary retail media, loyalty and promotion stacks, limiting third-party take rates. This risk is highest among scaled national retailers with strong engineering resources and large ad-sales teams.

Network fragmentation. Brands face a growing list of retail media networks, coupon networks, cash-back publishers and data clean rooms. Platforms that reduce fragmentation win; platforms that add another silo lose.

Legacy business decline. Paper coupon and traditional clearing volumes may decline faster than digital margins scale. Inmar's historical strength in coupon settlement is valuable, but the transition must be managed carefully.

5.4 Investable themes

- Outcome-based promotion platforms that get paid on confirmed sales, redemption or measurable conversion rather than impressions.
- Retailer-connected offer engines that integrate with loyalty, digital wallets, e-commerce and POS while preserving retailer customer ownership.
- AI-enabled fraud and offer optimization that reduces leakage, budget overruns and low-incrementality promotions.
- Mid-market and regional retailer retail media enablement where retailers lack resources to build proprietary networks.
- Regulated reverse-logistics analytics that converts compliance complexity into repeatable workflow revenue.

6. Most insightful industry trend bullets

- Digital coupons have crossed into mainstream grocery behavior, shifting competition from basic availability toward relevance, wallet integration and redemption reliability.
- Retail media growth is forcing retailers to balance advertiser monetization with customer experience, making personalization governance a strategic differentiator.
- CPG brands are moving from broad discounting toward measurable incentives that prove incrementality, reduce leakage and protect promotion budgets.
- First-party retail data is valuable but increasingly regulated, rewarding platforms with strong consent, privacy, security and retailer-control architectures.
- Healthcare reverse logistics is becoming a data and compliance workflow, expanding value beyond physical returns into traceability, analytics and policy automation.

7. Value chain analysis

7.1 Retail promotions, incentives and retail media value chain

Value-chain stage | What happens | Value added | Example participants | Source tier

CPG brand / advertiser planning | Brands define objectives such as trial, basket build, repeat purchase, lapsed-user reactivation, seasonal promotion. | Converts brand strategy into campaign budgets, target audiences, eligible SKUs and offer economics. | General Mills and other CPG advertisers cited by Inmar/Ibotta case examples. | Tier 2

Offer creation and funding | Offer values, UPC eligibility, retailer rules, budgets, timing and settlement terms are defined. | Creates executable incentives while controlling budget, stacking, eligibility and reimbursement obligations. | Inmar, Neptune, Catalina, Vericast. | Tier 2

Retailer / publisher integration | Offers are distributed through retailer apps, loyalty accounts, coupon galleries, email and third-party publishers. | Expands consumer reach and ties offers to authenticated shopper or transaction environment. | Retailer network, Ibotta IPN, Neptune retail partnerships, Swiftly regional network. | Tier 2

Consumer activation | Consumers discover, clip, load, redeem or receive cash back through digital coupons, wallets, mobile apps, retailer loyalty programs. | Converts marketing spend into shopper action while giving consumers visible savings. | Ibotta app, Checkout 51, Flipp, store loyalty programs. | Tier 2 / Tier 3

POS / e-commerce validation | Basket contents, UPCs, loyalty ID, offer terms and wallet status are evaluated at checkout. | Ensures offer eligibility and prevents fraud. | Retailer POS systems, Ibotta IPN, Neptune retail partnerships. | Tier 2

receipt submission. | Ensures eligible redemptions are recognized accurately and prevents duplicate or fraudulent
 Inmar Promotion Engine, Neptune UMO, Ibotta IPN, retailer POS systems. | Tier 2
 Clearing, settlement and reimbursement | Claims are reconciled, brands are billed, retailers are reimbursed and co
 receive discounts or rewards. | Provides trust, auditability and financial accuracy across multi-party transaction
 Vericast, Neptune, Ibotta. | Tier 2
 Measurement and optimization | Campaign performance is reported, sales lift is analyzed and future targeting or o
 optimized. | Demonstrates ROI, supports future budget allocation and improves personalization. | Inmar, Catalina,
 Epsilon/CitrusAd, Instacart, Ibotta. | Tier 2
 Retail media monetization | Retailers sell onsite/offsite/in-store media inventory using first-party data and clos
 measurement. | Creates high-margin retailer revenue and gives brands access to high-intent shoppers. | Criteo, Eps
 Instacart Ads, Swiftly, Inmar Retail Media. | Tier 2

7.2 Healthcare Rx returns value chain

Value-chain stage | What happens | Value added | Example participants | Source tier

Product becomes unsaleable | Pharmaceuticals expire, are recalled, damaged, overstocked or otherwise eligible for
 destruction. | Identifies economic recovery and compliance need. | Pharmacies, wholesalers, hospitals, life-scienc
 Tier 2
 Collection and shipment | Product is collected onsite or shipped to reverse distributor for processing. | Reduces
 workload and standardizes intake. | Inmar, Pharma Logistics, PharmaLink. | Tier 2
 Policy application and inventory | Items are inventoried, matched to manufacturer return goods policy and segment
 eligibility. | Maximizes credit recovery and ensures consistent policy application. | Inmar Rx Returns, PharmaLink
 Logistics portal. | Tier 2
 Credit and debit memo processing | Debit memos or credit documentation are generated and transmitted to trading pa
 Accelerates cash recovery and reduces reconciliation burden. | Inmar, Pharma Logistics, PharmaLink. | Tier 2
 Compliance and traceability | DSCSA, DEA and disposal documentation requirements are addressed where applicable. |
 regulatory risk and supports auditability. | FDA DSCSA framework; reverse distributors. | Tier 1 / Tier 2
 Disposal / destruction | Non-creditable or hazardous products are disposed of through compliant destruction partne
 safe, documented final disposition and supports diversion prevention. | Inmar disposal/destruction partners, Pharm
 PharmaLink. | Tier 2
 Reporting and analytics | Customers receive status, credit, inventory, policy and operational insights. | Converts
 logistics from cost center into data-enabled inventory and compliance management. | Inmar reporting, Pharma Logist
 portal, PharmaLink Encore. | Tier 2

8. Competitive landscape and top players

8.1 Market structure

The competitive landscape is fragmented because Inmar participates in several overlapping markets:

- Digital incentives and coupon networks: Inmar, Neptune, Ibotta, Catalina, Vericast, Flipp.
- Retail media and commerce media platforms: Criteo, Epsilon/CitrusAd, Instacart Ads, Swiftly, Skai, Vestcom, Inmar.
- Shopper intelligence and measurement: Catalina, Ibotta, Criteo, Epsilon, Instacart, Inmar.
- Coupon clearing and settlement: Inmar, Vericast, Neptune and legacy coupon-processing specialists.
- Healthcare reverse distribution: Inmar, Pharma Logistics, PharmaLink, Return Logistics, National Pharmaceutical Returns.

Reliable public market-share data for the full Inmar-relevant market is not available.

Company-reported scale metrics are therefore more useful than claimed share estimates. Inmar reports 240 million+ verified shoppers in its digital incentives ecosystem and 38% grocery ACV coverage. Inmar Incentives for Brands, Tier 2 (<https://www.inmar.com/solutions/martech/brands/incentives>) Ibotta reports access to 200 million+ consumers through leading retailers, publishers and owned properties. Ibotta IPN, Tier 2 (<https://ipn.ibotta.com/>) Neptune positions as North America's largest digital incentives network and cites exclusive integrations with major retailers including Albertsons, CVS Health, Dollar General, Target and Walgreens. Neptune, Tier 2 (<https://neptuneretailsolutions.com/solutions/digital-incentives/>) Criteo reports 4,000+ brands and 200+ retailers globally. Criteo, Tier 2 (<https://www.criteo.com/solutions/retail-media/>) Swiftly reports \$43 billion+ in sales powered across 33,000+ stores and 12 million+ shoppers, while also stating reach of more than 14 million shoppers in its retail media page. Swiftly, Tier 2 (<https://www.swiftly.com/products/retail-media>)

8.2 Major recent competitive developments

Ahold Delhaize USA switched from Neptune to Inmar. In January 2025, Ahold Delhaize USA announced that its five U.S. grocery brands - Food Lion, Giant Food, The GIANT Company, Hannaford and Stop & Shop - were live on Inmar's digital coupon platform. The release states Inmar replaced Neptune Retail Solutions, formerly Quotient, as ADUSA's digital coupon provider and had presented more than \$141 million in savings to ADUSA shoppers since launch. Ahold Delhaize USA, Tier 2 (<https://www.adusa.com/news-releases/news-release-details/ahold-delhaize-usa-brands-boost-personalization-and-value/>) Grocery Dive framed the move as part of grocers' push to ramp up online savings for price-sensitive consumers. Grocery Dive, Tier 3 (<https://www.grocerydive.com/news/ahold-delhaize-inmar-intelligence-digital-coupons-ecommerce/737019/>)

Neptune acquired Quotient. Neptune and Quotient combined in a transaction valued around \$430 million, bringing together in-store/print media, digital promotions, retail networks and proprietary data. Charlesbank, Tier 2 (<https://www.charlesbank.com/news/quotient-to-combine-with-neptune-retail-solutions/>) This increased Neptune's breadth and made it a more direct end-to-end competitor.

Ibotta became public and scaled retailer-publisher integrations. Ibotta's 2024 prospectus describes the IPN as a platform enabling CPG brands to deliver digital promotions to over 200 million consumers through a network of publishers, with major retailer relationships such as Walmart, Dollar General, Kroger and Shell. Ibotta SEC prospectus, Tier 1 (<https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1538379/000162828024016660/ibotta424b4finalprospectus.htm>)

Retail media platforms broadened beyond sponsored products. Criteo, Epsilon/CitrusAd and Instacart all emphasize closed-loop measurement, first-party data, onsite/offsite activation and AI-driven optimization. Criteo, Tier 2

(<https://www.criteo.com/solutions/retail-media/>); Publicis/Epsilon, Tier 2
(<https://www.epsilon.com/us/about-us/pressroom/publicis-groupe-launches-the-industrys-first-unified-on-site-and-off-site-retail-media-platform-citrusad-powered-by-epsilon/>);
Instacart, Tier 2
(<https://www.instacart.com/company/instacart-ads/growth-incremental-sales-and-scale>)

Patent disputes show IP sensitivity. Inmar and Neptune announced settlement of Inmar's digital coupon patent litigation in September 2025. Inmar Newsroom, Tier 2
(<https://www.inmar.com/blog/press/inmar-intelligence-and-neptune-retail-solutions-announce-settlement-digital-coupon>) The settlement reduces one known dispute but underscores that digital coupon validation and reimbursement methods can be IP-sensitive.

8.3 Competitive factors

Competitive factor | Why it matters | Inmar read-through

Retailer network coverage | Brands need broad reach; retailers need offer supply and operational reliability. | Inmar has 200 million+ verified shoppers and 38% grocery ACV are strong, but must be benchmarked against Ibotta, Neptune and retail media networks.

POS and loyalty integrations | Real-time basket evaluation and seamless redemption require deep technical integration. | Inmar's Promotion Engine and ADUSA win suggest capability; diligence should test implementation speed and uptime.

Offer inventory and CPG demand | Retailers prefer networks with strong national brand offer supply; brands prefer networks with broad reach. | Demand generation and brand relationships are central to Inmar's proposition.

Measurement and incrementality | Advertisers want proof that spend drives incremental sales, not subsidized baseline. | Inmar's closed-loop measurement is important; methodology transparency should be diligenced.

Fraud prevention and offer controls | Duplicate redemption, stacking and fake coupons create leakage and brand dilution. | Inmar's settlement heritage may be an advantage if paired with modern universal coupon standards.

Retail media breadth | Retailers want onsite, offsite, in-store and influencer monetization. | Inmar is broadening its reach. | Criteo/Epsilon/Instacart have deeper media-platform narratives.

Data governance and privacy | First-party data use is increasingly sensitive and regulated. | Inmar has legal/privacy expertise, but controls require detailed diligence.

Healthcare compliance | Rx returns require accurate policy, traceability and documented disposition. | Inmar appears to have strong segment performance and compliance history should be validated.

9. Market positioning for target and peers

9.1 Peer positioning insights

- Neptune positions around omnichannel reach, exclusive retailer integrations, UMO security and Checkout 51 cash back, emphasizing scale and fraud reduction.
- Ibotta differentiates through pay-per-sale digital promotions, AI-enabled offer matching, retailer-publisher integrations and access to 200 million+ consumers.
- Catalina emphasizes deterministic shopper intelligence, personalized CPG marketing and real-time measurement across audience finding, activation and optimization.
- Criteo and Epsilon/CitrusAd frame retail media as a global, AI-powered, first-party data platform with closed-loop SKU-level measurement.
- Swiftly targets regional and independent grocers, positioning as a practical retail media and loyalty platform for retailers lacking national-chain resources.

9.2 Inmar's positioning

- Inmar differentiates through the combination of incentive creation, real-time basket evaluation, settlement heritage, retailer network access and closed-loop measurement.
- The company is broader than pure coupon apps because it serves retailers, CPG brands, healthcare manufacturers, pharmacies and wholesalers across transaction workflows.
- ADUSA's switch from Neptune to Inmar indicates retailers may value offer capacity, relevant savings, efficiency and customer experience improvements.
- Inmar's healthcare segment provides regulated workflow diversification, but investors should test whether it shares technology advantages with martech or operates separately.
- AI, RPA and machine learning are positioned as enterprise-wide capabilities, creating potential margin upside if applied to reconciliation and returns-processing automation.

10. Competitive heat map

Company	Core overlap with Inmar	Product / service breadth	Geographic presence	Heat-map category	Notes
Inmar Intelligence	Digital incentives, coupon settlement, retail media, loyalty, analytics, Rx returns	Broad	America-centered with support operations beyond	Broad / National-North American	Most diversified across commercial and healthcare workflows.
Neptune Retail Solutions	Digital incentives, cash back, in-store media, digital media	Broad	North America	American	Very direct promotions competitor with major retailer integrations.
Ibotta	Digital promotions, cash back, performance marketing, retailer-publisher network	Medium-Broad	U.S.-centered	Medium-Broad / National	Strong pay-per-sale and retailer integration model.
Catalina / Infillion	Shopper intelligence, personalized promotions, media activation, measurement	Medium-Broad	U.S.-centered	Medium-Broad / National	Strong purchase-data and CPG personalization heritage.
Vericast / Valassis	Coupons, direct mail, digital offers, universal coupon	Medium	U.S.	Medium / National	Long heritage; less clear retail media platform breadth.
Swiftly	Retail media, loyalty, digital coupons for regional/independent retailers	Medium	U.S.	Medium / National	Differentiated among independent and regional grocers.
Criteo	Retail media and commerce media platform	Medium-Broad	Global	Medium-Broad / Global	Strong media platform; less direct settlement/returns overlap.
Epsilon / CitrusAd	Onsite/offsite retail media, identity, clean rooms, measurement	Broad	Global	Broad / Global	Strong enterprise media and identity capabilities.
Instacart Ads	Grocery marketplace ads, coupons, closed-loop measurement	Medium	North America	Medium / North American	Powerful grocery media ecosystem anchored to Instacart.
Vestcom / Avery Dennison	Shelf-edge media, pricing/promotion content, in-store retail media	Medium	U.S.	Medium / North American	Strong in-store decision-point media rather than digital wallet settlement.
Flipp	Digital circulars, flyers, coupons, deal discovery	Narrow-Medium	U.S. / Canada	Narrow-Medium / North American	Consumer-facing savings discovery; indirect enterprise overlap.
Pharma Logistics	Pharmaceutical reverse distribution, disposal, analytics	Narrow	U.S.	Narrow / National	Healthcare returns competitor only.
PharmaLink	Pharmaceutical reverse distribution and returns reporting	Narrow	U.S.	Narrow / National	Direct returns competitor only.
Skai	Retail media campaign management across networks	Medium	Global	Medium / Global	Indirect retail media competitor.

11. Value creation levers and risks

VCL or Risk	Title	Description
VCL	Digital incentive migration	Inmar can capture share as promotion dollars move from paper and broad discount coupons, cash back and wallet-linked offers with measurable redemption.
VCL	Retailer network expansion	Additional retailer integrations expand consumer reach and brand demand, reinforcing effects if Inmar can simplify implementation and prove reliable checkout performance.
VCL	Closed-loop ROI analytics	Stronger incrementality, attribution and campaign optimization tools can help Inmar

pricing and win CPG budgets under marketing ROI scrutiny.

VCL | AI-driven offer efficiency | Machine learning can personalize offer value, reduce wasted discounts, forecast liability and improve retailer/brand outcomes without simply increasing promotion spend.

VCL | Universal coupon enablement | Secure, serialized digital coupon standards can reduce fraud and make Inmar's heritage more valuable in omnichannel coupon execution.

VCL | Healthcare compliance complexity | DSCSA and returns-policy complexity can support demand for Inmar's Rx Return platform improves credit recovery and audit readiness.

VCL | Operating automation | RPA and AI can lower reconciliation, settlement and returns-processing cost per transaction margin upside as digital volumes scale.

Risk | Retailer insourcing | Large retailers may internalize loyalty, retail media and promotion tools, reducing Inmar's or relegating it to lower-value processing roles.

Risk | Attribution commoditization | Closed-loop measurement is becoming standard, so Inmar must prove superior in optimization rather than relying on generic sales attribution claims.

Risk | Privacy enforcement | FTC scrutiny of data monetization, AI and sensitive information can increase compliance constrain targeting if governance is not demonstrably robust.

Risk | Legacy volume decline | Paper coupon and traditional clearing economics may decline faster than digital incentives retail media replace contribution margin.

Risk | Customer concentration | Major retailer wins create scale but can increase dependence on few partners, making pricing and service-level performance critical.

Risk | Competitive network pressure | Neptune, Ibotta, Catalina and retailer-owned networks compete for the same CPG potentially raising incentives, lowering fees or fragmenting reach.

Risk | Healthcare compliance failure | Errors in Rx returns, product disposition, DSCSA support or destruction documentation create regulatory, customer and reputational exposure.

12. Investor diligence priorities

12.1 Commercial diligence

Investors should start by building a revenue bridge across martech, incentives, coupon settlement, retail media, analytics and healthcare. Public sources do not provide Inmar's current segment revenue or margin mix. The most important diligence questions are:

- What percentage of revenue is recurring, transaction-based, implementation-based or campaign-based?
- How fast are digital incentives growing relative to paper coupon clearing?
- What is gross retention and net revenue retention by retailer, CPG brand and healthcare customer cohort?
- How concentrated is revenue among top retailers and manufacturers?
- How much of reported shopper reach is active, addressable and monetizable in any given campaign?
- What is the realized take rate per redemption, campaign, settlement transaction or Rx return?
- How do Inmar's ROI claims compare with retailer-controlled measurement and third-party incrementality studies?

12.2 Product and technology diligence

The key product diligence question is whether Inmar is a modern software platform with scalable workflow automation or a tech-enabled services business requiring significant manual operations. The answer may differ by segment. Diligence should assess:

- POS, loyalty, wallet and e-commerce integration architecture.
- Real-time basket evaluation accuracy and latency.
- Campaign setup workflow, in-flight modification and self-service capabilities.
- Fraud detection, duplicate redemption prevention and offer stacking controls.
- Data model for shopper identity, transaction history, product eligibility and offer attribution.
- AI/RPA use cases already in production versus marketing roadmap.
- Cybersecurity, privacy, data retention, consent and clean-room capabilities.
- Technical debt from historical acquisitions or legacy coupon-processing systems.

12.3 Market and competitive diligence

The ADUSA win is strategically encouraging, but it should not be overgeneralized without additional evidence. Investors should validate:

- Why ADUSA switched from Neptune to Inmar and how performance has compared against expectations.
- Whether Inmar is winning new retailers or mainly defending existing relationships.
- Where Ibotta's pay-per-sale economics are more attractive to CPG brands than Inmar's model.
- Whether Criteo, Epsilon/CitrusAd and Instacart are expanding from media into incentives and loyalty.
- How manufacturers allocate budgets among trade promotion, coupons, cashback, retail media and national media.
- Whether regional grocers prefer Swiftly-type turnkey platforms or Inmar-type promotion networks.

12.4 Healthcare diligence

Inmar's healthcare business may provide diversification and compliance-driven durability. Investors should separately analyze:

- Revenue mix by pharmacies, wholesalers, life-sciences companies and destruction/disposal services.
- Credit recovery performance and customer ROI versus Pharma Logistics and PharmaLink.
- Regulatory audit history, controlled-substance handling controls and DSCSA readiness.
- Operating model: onsite service, mail-in processing, automation level, policy database maintenance and analytics monetization.
- Cross-segment synergies with martech, if any, versus standalone healthcare services economics.

13. Bottom-line investment view

Inmar is an established, transaction-rich platform in markets undergoing digital migration. Its historical coupon settlement role remains relevant because digital promotions still require validation, clearing, reimbursement, fraud control and trust

between retailers and manufacturers. The company appears to have extended that heritage into digital incentives, loyalty technology, retail media workflows and healthcare Rx returns.

The attractive investor thesis is that Inmar can transform from a legacy processing intermediary into a higher-growth, data-enabled performance platform. This thesis is supported by the rise of digital coupons, persistent consumer value-seeking, retail media growth, first-party data monetization, and regulated healthcare reverse-logistics complexity. The ADUSA digital coupon win provides tangible evidence that Inmar remains competitive against major peers.

The principal underwriting risk is that market growth may accrue disproportionately to retailers, large retail media platforms or pay-per-sale networks rather than to independent coupon settlement incumbents. Investors should avoid treating broad retail media forecasts as directly addressable revenue. Instead, the diligence case should be built around Inmar's verified transaction volumes, net take rates, segment-level margins, digital mix shift, customer retention and automation-driven operating leverage.

If diligence confirms strong retailer retention, growing digital redemption volume, credible incrementality measurement, defensible data governance and margin expansion from automation, Inmar could be positioned as a valuable infrastructure platform for measurable shopper engagement. If legacy paper economics remain material, retailer concentration is high, or retail media capabilities are less differentiated than peers, the opportunity would require a more conservative underwriting case focused on cash flow durability rather than growth multiple expansion.

Appendix: Sources and tiering

Source tier definitions

Tier | Definition used in this report

Tier 1 | Government, public agencies, statistical bodies and regulatory filings, including SEC filings, FDA, FTC, Census-sourced FRED data.

Tier 2 | Company websites, company reports, company newsroom releases, consulting firms and official investor/owner

Tier 3 | Financial news, trade publications and industry association publications.

Tier 4 | Market research aggregators, blogs, unverified forums and similar sources. Avoided as primary support.

Tier 1 sources

Source | Link | Used for

U.S. Census Bureau via FRED - E-commerce retail sales share | <https://fred.stlouisfed.org/data/ECOMPCTSA.txt> | Historical e-commerce penetration trend.

U.S. Census Bureau via FRED - E-commerce retail sales dollars | <https://fred.stlouisfed.org/data/ECOMSA.txt> | Historical e-commerce dollar growth.

U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics CPI review | <https://www.bls.gov/opub/ted/2024/consumer-price-index-2023-in-review> | Food-at-home inflation and value-seeking context.

BLS CPI food and beverages via FRED | <https://fred.stlouisfed.org/data/CPIFABSL.txt> | Food/beverage price-level trend

Federal Trade Commission privacy and data security update | <https://www.ftc.gov/news-events/news/press-releases/2024/03/ftc-releases-2023-privacy-data-security-update> | Privacy

monetization risk.

FDA DSCSA law and policies |

<https://www.fda.gov/drugs/drug-supply-chain-security-act-dscsa/drug-supply-chain-security-act-law-and-policies> | FDA supply-chain traceability and compliance context.

Ibotta IPO prospectus filed with SEC |

<https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1538379/000162828024016660/ibotta424b4finalprospectus.htm> | Digital promotion definitions, grocery market size, CPG marketing spend and Ibotta model.

Ibotta 2024 Form 10-K | <https://investors.ibotta.com/sec-filings/all-sec-filings/content/0001628280-25-008240/ibotta-2024-form-10-k> | Public-company competitor context and risk factors.

Tier 2 sources

Source | Link | Used for

Inmar About | <https://www.inmar.com/about> | Company history and positioning.

Inmar Incentives for Brands | <https://www.inmar.com/solutions/martech/brands/incentives> | Digital incentives offered and metrics.

Inmar Incentives & Loyalty for Retailers | <https://www.inmar.com/solutions/martech/retailers/incentives-loyalty> | Digital incentives, Engine, loyalty and retailer workflow capabilities.

Inmar Retail Media | <https://www.inmar.com/solutions/martech/retailers/retail-media> | Retail media, ShopperReach and marketing positioning.

Inmar Rx Returns | <https://www.inmar.com/solutions/healthcare/supply-chain-solutions/rx-returns> | Healthcare reverse logistics capabilities.

Inmar Leadership | <https://www.inmar.com/about/leadership> | Management, AI, privacy/security leadership and board.

Inmar AI/ML | <https://www.inmar.com/about/ai-ml> | AI, GenAI, RPA and ML positioning.

Inmar-Neptune patent settlement |

<https://www.inmar.com/blog/press/inmar-intelligence-and-neptune-retail-solutions-announce-settlement-digital-coupons> | Competitive/IP development.

ABRY Partners OMERS acquisition announcement | <https://abry.com/news-article/omers-acquires-majority-interest-in-inmar> | Ownership and company background.

OMERS Inmar investment page | <https://www.omersprivateequity.com/investments/inmar> | Ownership and customer count.

Atairos Inmar partner page | <https://www.atairos.com/partner-companies/inmar-intelligence/> | Partner-company description and client count.

Ahold Delhaize USA Inmar announcement |

<https://www.adusa.com/news-releases/news-release-details/ahold-delhaize-usa-brands-boost-personalization-and-value> | Customer win and Neptune displacement.

Neptune Digital Incentives | <https://neptuneretailsolutions.com/solutions/digital-incentives/> | Competitor capabilities and claims.

Ibotta Performance Network | <https://ipn.ibotta.com/> | Competitor capabilities and scale claims.

Catalina | <https://www.catalina.com/> | Competitor positioning and shopper intelligence capabilities.

Swiftly Retail Media | <https://www.swiftly.com/products/retail-media> | Competitor positioning for regional grocery.

Criteo Retail Media | <https://www.criteo.com/solutions/retail-media/> | Retail media competitor scale and capabilities.

Publicis/Epsilon CitrusAd press release |

<https://www.epsilon.com/us/about-us/pressroom/publicis-groupe-launches-the-industrys-first-unified-on-site-and-off-site-retail-media-platform-citrusad-powered-by-epsilon> | Retail media competitor capabilities and scale.

Instacart Ads ecosystem | <https://www.instacart.com/company/instacart-ads/growth-incremental-sales-and-scale> | Grocery retail media competitor positioning.

Vestcom solutions | <https://www.vestcom.com/solutions/> | Shelf-edge and in-store media competitor capabilities.

Flipp | <https://flipp.com/> | Digital circular, coupon and deal-discovery peer context.

Pharma Logistics | <https://pharmalogistics.com/> | Healthcare reverse-distribution competitor capabilities.

PharmaLink | <https://pharmalinkinc.com/> | Healthcare reverse-distribution competitor capabilities.

Skai retail media solutions | <https://skai.io/retail-media-solutions/> | Retail media campaign-management peer context.

Deloitte retail media personalization |

<https://www.deloitte.com/us/en/programs/chief-marketing-officer/articles/personalization-strategy-in-retail-media> | Retail media outlook, personalization and data infrastructure implications.

McKinsey commerce media analysis |

<https://www.mckinsey.com/capabilities/growth-marketing-and-sales/our-insights/the-evolution-of-commerce-media-navigation-in-advertising> | Commerce media growth outlook.

Tier 3 sources

Source | Link | Used for

FMI 2024 U.S. Grocery Shopper Trends release |
<https://www.fmi.org/newsroom/news-archive/view/2024/05/14/fmi-launches-2024-u.s.-grocery-shopper-trends-series--h-finding-value-at-the-grocery-store> | Shopper value behavior, digital coupon use and mobile price comparison.
Grocery Dive ADUSA-Inmar article |
<https://www.grocerydive.com/news/ahold-delhaize-inmar-intelligence-digital-coupons-ecommerce/737019/> | Industry co
ADUSA switch and grocery value trends.
Vericast Universal Coupon PRNewswire release |
<https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/vericast-leads-innovation-and-promotes-adoption-of-universal-coupons-at-s-tml> | Universal coupon and serialized coupon context.

Tier 4 sources

No Tier 4 source was used as a primary source in this report.